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Daily brief · 2026-08-19

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Last 7 daily reports

3 deep-dives you should really read

Block's new Apache 2.0 agent workspace Berd works across models and harnesses, stores conversation history locally

VentureBeat – AI · Topic: **AI/Cloud/Quantum**

- **What it is:** Berd is an open-source, Apache 2.0 licensed desktop application from Block that provides a unified workspace for interacting with various AI agents and models, storing conversation history locally.
- **Who:** Block, the technology company behind Square, Cash App, and Tidal, developed and open-sourced Berd, originally for its employees to manage diverse AI agents.
- **What it does:** Berd provides a consistent desktop environment for users to manage various AI agents, models, and projects, allowing persistent work, context preservation, and visible operational state.
- **Why it matters:** Berd matters by addressing AI agent fragmentation, enhancing productivity through persistent context, and making agentic work accessible across an enterprise, fostering a robust open-source ecosystem.
- **Strategic view:** Block strategically positions itself in enterprise AI by open-sourcing a unified agent orchestration layer and runtime, influencing industry standards, and democratizing agentic work for TMT organizations.

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85% of companies burned by an AI mistake are racing to cut the humans who might catch the next one

VentureBeat – AI · Topic: **AI/Cloud/Quantum**

- **What it is:** VentureBeat research reveals that nearly half of enterprises experience customer-visible AI failures even after systems pass internal testing, exposing a critical evaluation gap.
- **Who:** Enterprises deploying AI agents and large language models are central, alongside automated evaluation systems and the human teams overseeing AI deployment pipelines.
- **What it does:** Despite past AI failures, 85% of affected companies are paradoxically accelerating efforts to remove human oversight from AI deployment decisions, moving towards greater automation.
- **Why it matters:** This trend creates a dangerous disconnect where increased confidence in automated evaluations does not translate to improved production reliability, amplifying operational risks and customer impact.
- **Strategic view:** TMT executives must prioritize robust, continuous AI monitoring and re-evaluate human-in-the-loop strategies, focusing on post-deployment validation to prevent escalating failures and reputational damage.

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Enterprises are overpaying for simple AI queries — Snowflake's gateway now auto-routes to cut costs up to 3x

VentureBeat – AI · Topic: **AI/Cloud/Quantum**

- **What it is:** Snowflake's Cortex AI Gateway now offers dynamic model routing, automatically selecting the most cost-effective and appropriate AI model for enterprise tasks to optimize performance and reduce expenditure.
- **Who:** Snowflake is targeting enterprises running AI agents at scale, offering its new dynamic model routing capabilities to help them manage and reduce costs associated with diverse AI workloads.
- **What it does:** The gateway intelligently routes AI queries using advisor patterns and classifiers, optimizing model choice to cut token costs by up to 3x while integrating with existing data governance and access controls.
- **Why it matters:** This matters because enterprises currently overpay for simple AI queries by using overly complex models, and this solution offers a critical pathway to significantly reduce operational costs and improve efficiency at scale.
- **Strategic view:** TMT executives must strategically evaluate AI model routing solutions based on their alignment with existing data governance frameworks, security boundaries, and cost attribution, moving beyond just raw model performance.

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CEO POV · AI & Space Economy

No CEO statements collected for today.

Patent watch · Compute / Video / Data / Cloud

No relevant patent publications detected for today (EPO / USPTO).

Curated watchlist · 3-5 links per topic

TV / Streaming

No notable articles for this topic today.

Telco / 5G

No notable articles for this topic today.

Media / Platforms

No notable articles for this topic today.

AI / Cloud / Quantum

- [GLM-5.3 hits the API at \\$1.4/\\$4.4 per million tokens](#) (VentureBeat – AI) ☐ Add to Weekly
- [Commerce AI is fragmenting. Here is why that matters.](#) (VentureBeat – AI) ☐ Add to Weekly
- [AI’s recursive self-improvement might not come so quickly after all](#) (MIT Technology Review – Tech) ☐ Add to Weekly
- [The Download: how people really use AI, and Flock’s design choices](#) (MIT Technology Review – Tech) ☐ Add to Weekly
- [We still don’t know how people are really using AI](#) (MIT Technology Review – Tech) ☐ Add to Weekly

Space / Infrastructure

- [Wildfires, drought and extreme heat, 2026](#) (ESA – European Space Agency) ☐ Add to Weekly
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